CLAIMS

What is claimed is:

1. A method for creating a verifiable record of possession of non-public information, comprising the steps of:

    - receiving a piece of non-public information concerning a future action to be taken by an organization;
    - preparing a written document that addresses or incorporates said non-public information;
    - submitting said written document to an independent, third-party time-stamping authority, thereby creating a first verifiable timestamp (T1); and
    - subsequently receiving an official communication from the organization which makes the non-public information public, said communication having a second verifiable timestamp (T2), wherein T2 is later than T1.

2. The method of claim 1, wherein the independent, third-party time-stamping authority is a commercial courier service.

3. The method of claim 1, wherein the non-public information is the specific reason for the future rejection of a previously submitted document.

4. The method of claim 3, wherein the prepared written document is an amended version of the previously submitted document which corrects the specific reason for rejection.

5. A method for demonstrating the existence of an information leak within an organization, comprising:

    - obtaining foreknowledge of a specific, detailed outcome of an internal process within the organization;

- generating a tangible work product that demonstrates said foreknowledge;
- causing said tangible work product to be verifiably time-stamped by a trusted entity external to the organization; and
- preserving the record of said time-stamp for a future comparison against the time at which the organization publicly or officially discloses the outcome of its internal process.

6. The method of claim 5, wherein the tangible work product is a legal document and the trusted entity is a package delivery service.